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Dr. Pippin Barr

CART 253

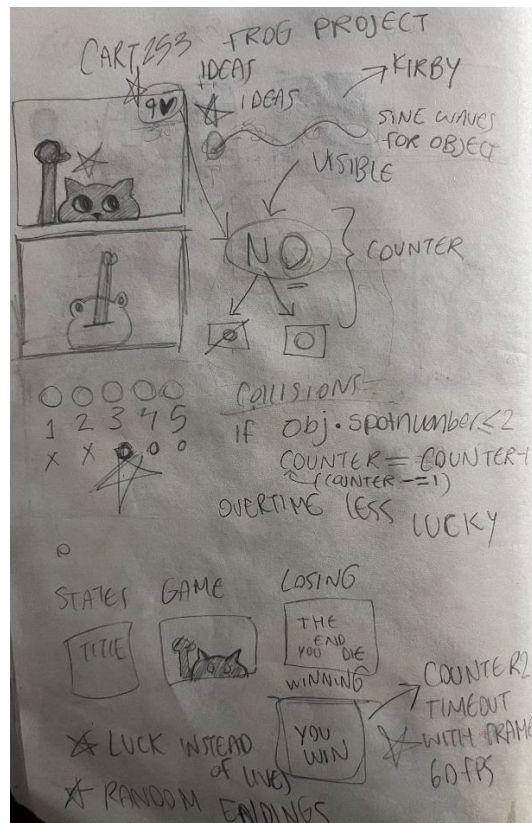
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Final Reflection

Throughout this course I have developed a less mystified relationship with coding. With the structure provided by the course, I have learnt to differentiate and categorize the components of a programming language. This is important in my journey, as I am now able to consider the actions I want to take and their relationship to a project's creative direction. An example of this is using conditionals to provide a variety of options to the person interacting with my work.

Initially, upon entering the program last year I had no relationship with programming. However, as mentioned in my pre reflection after a year in the Computation Arts program, I realized I had always been indirectly connected to it through everyday technologies. Programming represented a collective historical effort to create modern tools, and this perspective inspired me. During my time in the course, I began clearly envisioning programming to create interactive art that preserves cultural elements and challenges our increasingly intangible lives.

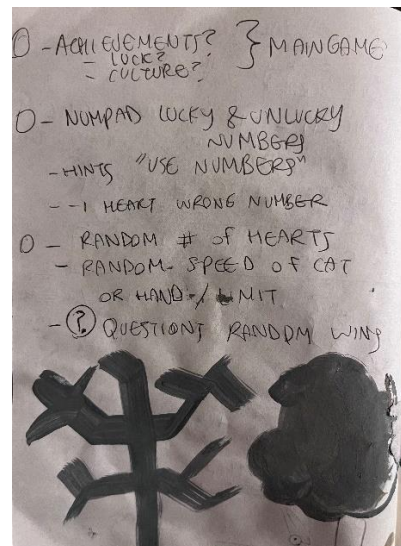
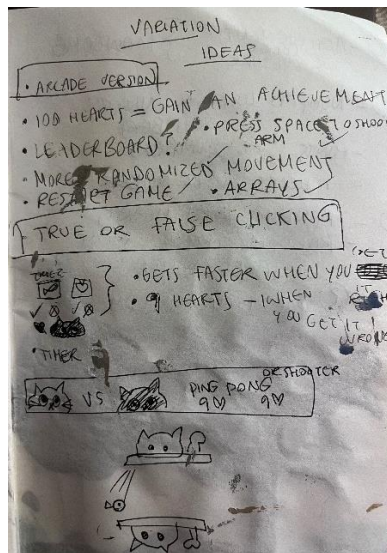
My first project was made using p5js utilized only shapes to get me more comfortable with the technical aspects of coding. I did not brainstorm much but this project gave me the idea to implement interesting questions and philosophies towards my second project as I realized having a strong base can make the workflow more intuitive.



Initial sketches for my modification jam included coming up with ideas then asking for help from Mathilde on what ways I could code the project. For example, how I could utilize collisions. This initial version familiarized me with if statements, game states, collisions, and movement related codes. For example, I understood that depending on the game state, both the visual elements and the scope the actions of the player would have to be different thereby requiring an if statement. Other elements that were required was an array for death messages. The sound aspect required both player interaction which I had learnt to code for the previous project and a loop to continue playing music.

```
function mousePressed() {
  // Plays music if it's not already playing and loops it
  if (music && !music.isPlaying()) {
    music.loop();
  }
  // checks to see if the game is on start, which it is at the beginn.
  if (gameState === "start") {
    //Changes the state to play when the mouse is pressed
    gameState = "game";
  }
}
```

example of my usage of if statements, game state, and a loop



For the variation jam, after consulting with professor pippin, I decided to push on the concepts of chance and the philosophy of value behind my modification jam. For one of these I wanted to use a JSON array to organize objects as that was something that made sense with my previous code. Overall, making the variations depended on both prior experiences and experimentation.

```
const ladybug = {
  image: undefined,
  lucky: true, //lucky determines if each object is going to take away or add aces
  x: 0, //this is just the starting x
  y: 200, //will be random
  size: 100,
  speed: 4 //lucky items are faster than unlucky ones to make it hard to win
};

const itchyfoot = {
  image: undefined,
  lucky: false,
  x: -100,
  y: 300,
  size: 100,
  speed: 3
};
```

```
{ "objects": [
  {
    "name": "ladybug",
    "image": "assets/images/LadyBug.png",
    "lucky": true,
    "x": 0,
    "y": 200,
    "size": 100,
    "speed": 4
  },
  {
    "name": "itchyfoot",
    "image": "assets/images/FootItch.png",
    "lucky": false,
    "x": -100,
    "y": 300,
    "size": 100,
    "speed": 3
  }
],
```

My first projects did not use an array for my objects, in my second project there was visible improvement in using data structures in the array of my JSON file.

I think having had the chance to learn about interactivity has opened up my mind to other forms of interactive installations and piqued my curiosity. The process of making the three variations was very hard for me, as I think I am still an unpractised programmer. However, I feel comfortable doing simple interactive codes especially light-hearted animations and movements. I would like to utilize my knowledge to create worlds where my other works can be livelier. Primarily for my future work I am interested in the ways viewers could interact with paintings or other visual works I have made.

If I were to plan this more concretely, conditionals could be used alongside a map function to follow the movement of the viewers finger or mouse, showcasing layers that move slightly. Each layer could be held in a separate “let” which can be manipulated as a variable for animations and interactivity later. A preload function would be useful to lessen the time it takes to interact with the layers. Looping sounds is something I enjoy adding for immersivity so this could be included as well. Other interesting avenues include using video-photography and random functions to showcase a non-linear storyline each time a player interacts with the canvas.